

	UNIFIED FIRE AUTHORITY ORGANIZATIONAL POLICY MANUAL	
	Affiliation: Administration Policies	
	Title: UFA Employee Organization Policy Number: 100 – 060	
	Approved: 11/8/2022	By: Fire Chief Dominic Burchett
	Last Reviewed:	By:

DEFINITIONS:

Employee – A person in the paid employment of the Unified Fire Authority (UFA)

Employee Organization – A group of UFA employees who have formally joined together through written agreement to promote employee issues and concerns.

LEADERS INTENT:

To provide a consistent, uniform, and equitable procedure which supports, promotes, and maintains a positive labor relations climate between employee organizations, UFA employees and UFA Administration.

PURPOSE:

To provide guidelines for the officers of employee organizations, certification, and decertification of employee organizations, and for interaction by UFA with employee organizations. The policy provides for the recognition of employee organizations. It is not the intent of this policy to limit in any way the ability of any organization or citizen to interact with the UFA as outlined in state statute or local ordinance.

POLICY:

1.0 Recruitment Practices

- 1.1 Employee organizations wishing to recruit UFA employees must identify their target group(s) before such recruiting may occur. The identification of target groups must be in writing and submitted to the Fire Chief.
- 1.2 The UFA may allow any employee organization that has a membership of 50 or more UFA employees or has a membership of 30% or more of the target UFA employee group in its organization (whichever is less), and a membership of at least 15 employees, certain opportunities within the UFA. Employee organizations meeting the above criteria may be afforded the following:
 - 1.2.1 Copies of agendas for the UFA Board meetings
 - 1.2.2 List of UFA employees by name and work assignment. The data shall not include confidential information such as home addresses or phone numbers.

- 1.2.3 Ability to contact UFA employees on UFA premises during their break and lunch periods to recruit employees and discuss organization activities.

2.0 Time Allocations

- 2.1 Employee organizations may be allowed time each month during UFA working hours for employees who are officers of the employee organization to attend to organization business. This privilege is limited to:
 - President and/or Vice President – 10 hours
 - Executive Board (limit 2 members) – 6 hours
 - Trustees (limit 5 members) – 3 hours
- 2.1.1 Additional leave may be granted for events, meetings, and processes that are approved by the Fire Chief or designee.
 - 2.1.1.1 The Fire Chief or designee may limit the approvals of the special leave to no more than two employees per shift.
 - 2.1.1.2 Requests for additional leave should be made to the Fire Chief or designee, in writing, at least fourteen (14) days prior to the requested leave.
- 2.2 Such monthly time allotment is a maximum that cannot, if unused, be carried over.
- 2.3 Each employee member must give timely notification to his/her supervisor prior to attending any such meetings.
 - 2.3.1 Employees are required to find their own backfill coverage, notify the Staffing Office with the name(s) of their replacement(s), and if working in Operations may not leave their assignment until properly relieved.
- 2.4 If an employee holds more than one position in one or more organizations, he/she will receive the greater of the monthly hourly allotment but not the aggregate total.
- 2.5 There is no limit on employee involvement outside of UFA working hours.
- 2.6 By January 15th of each year, employee organizations will provide a list of officers to the UFA for approval of time to work on employee issues.

3.0 Payroll Deductions

- 3.1 Employee organizations must have at least 15 members to be eligible for payroll deduction of dues.

- 4.0 Employee Representation – Employee organizations will have the right to represent employees in resolving personnel – related issues including grievances.

5.0 Advisory Status

- 5.1 Employee organizations are advisory in nature. Recommendations and decisions made by employee organizations shall not bind the UFA in any manner.
- 5.2 Employee organization representatives shall not serve as voting members on UFA boards and councils dealing with employee policies. This does not preclude UFA employees who are members of an employee organization from serving on the UFA Policy Advisory Committee.
- 5.3 Any relationship with an employee organization shall exclude collective bargaining agreements.
- 5.4 Right to Strike
 - 5.4.1 Employees belonging to employee organizations shall not have the right to strike under any circumstances.

6.0 Relation with the UFA

- 6.1 Employee organizations are encouraged to communicate with the UFA regarding major employee issues affecting all employees through the Fire Chief who will in turn direct the information to the appropriate division representative.

Replaces policy dated July 1, 2004, and former policy Employee Association Time Allotment